

Mabelle and **Rajanikant Arole** were a physician couple who founded the Comprehensive Rural Health Project (CRHP) to improve rural health in India. India's villages have historically suffered from a severe shortage of doctors. With this in mind, the Aroles pioneered a new method of helping people help each other. In 1970, they began the CRHP in Jamkhed, a poor, drought-stricken region of Maharashtra, to help people prevent minor ailments and diseases through better nutrition, access to clean water and education. The Aroles trained local women to observe symptoms, do simple tests and teach their peers about better hygiene and preventive measures against common diseases. As a result, health indicators in Jamkhed improved significantly. The project's success led to the Aroles' approach being adopted in dozens of countries across the world.

"…THE SOLUTION IS NOT TO BUILD A CLINIC, BUT TO CHANGE THE PEOPLE'S ATTITUDES TOWARDS WOMEN, CHILDREN, AND THE POOR."

RAJANIKANT AROLE

1934–2011